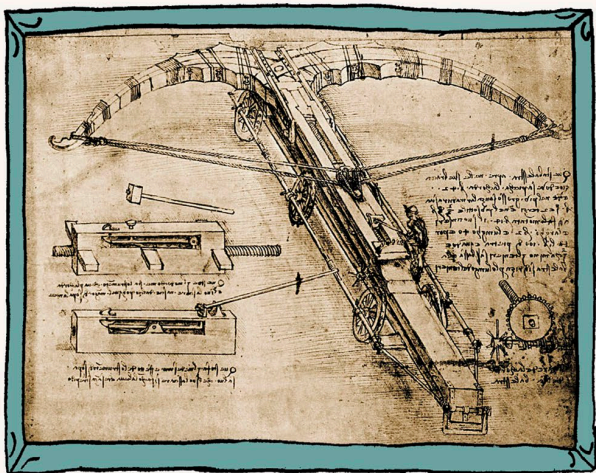




Leonardo drew a giant crossbow for use in warfare.
He sketched the mechanisms to make it work, too.

The leaders of Florence were worried that their city might be Borgia's next target. In 1502, hoping to avoid a conflict they feared they would lose, they sent two of their most respected citizens to meet Borgia and try to keep the peace.

Leonardo was one of those citizens. While he wasn't a trained negotiator, he was willing to offer his services to Borgia as a military engineer—so long as his skills were not used against Florence.

